US MARINE WEAPONS

Much of the kit used by Marines in Vietnam was of World War II or Korean War vintage. The M14 rifle in use in 1965 was a direct descendant of the WWII M1 Garand, although it was largely replaced by the innovative M16 from 1967. Hand-launched parachute flares were employed when defending against night attacks. Insect repellant was an essential in the jungle.

M7 knife and M8 scabbard
The M7 knife doubled as both a fighting knife and a bayonet. The M8 scabbard was used for a number of knife models.

Web carrying strap

Non-slip grip

Carbon steel blade sharpened both sides

M8 SCABBARD

M7 KNIFE

Canteen and cup
Aluminium canteens held a US quart (950ml) of water and nested inside the canteen cup as shown. Cans were sometimes pierced to use as makeshift stoves.

MAP OF SAIGON BASE AREA



Rifle fore sight

Grenade fore sight, folded down

M203 grenade launcher

Loading/ ejector slide



PARACHUTE FLARE

ANGLE HEAD FLASHLIGHT

1941 pack
Part of a top and bottom pack system to hold rations and personal effects, the second pack could be worn underneath the first. The rolled piece of canvas or shelter-half formed half of a "pup" tent when snapped to a second piece.

Rolled canvas shelter-half

Mitchell pattern camouflage issued only to Marine Corps

M1943 folding entrenching shovel